

PATRICK MAHDI O'NEILL

International Finance Trainer & Financial Adviser

940+
Training Days

200+
Engagements

73
Clients

CONTACT

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LOCATION
Dubai, UAE

LINKEDIN
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PROFILE

NATIONALITY
Irish

DOB
18 January 1974

COUNTRIES
UAE, KSA, Kuwait, Oman, Switzerland, UK, US

EXPERTISE

- Wealth Management
- Islamic Finance
- ESG & Sustainable Finance
- Financial Crime & Compliance
- Risk in Financial Services
- Credit & Bank Analysis
- Banking Foundations
- AI Fluency in Finance
- Real Estate Finance

TRAINING PARTNERS

- Fitch Learning
- LIBF
- ADGM Academy
- Leoron
- Tadawul Academy
- EMFT
- QFC
- CCL Academy

PROFILE

Finance trainer and adviser with 25+ years across GCC, MENA and UK markets. Specialist in Islamic Finance, ESG & Sustainable Finance, Financial Crime, Wealth Management, Risk and AI Fluency in Finance — delivering qualification-focused and bespoke programmes from graduate to C-Suite level, with every programme running on the same AI-augmented workflow he teaches. Actively regulated as an FCA-authorised IFA in the UK.

EXPERIENCE

International Finance Trainer *Apr 2015 – Present*

- Delivering specialist training in Wealth Management, Islamic Finance, ESG & Sustainable Finance, Financial Crime, Risk, Credit Analysis, and Banking Foundations across GCC, MENA and UK — from graduate induction to C-Suite executive education.
- 940+ training days across 200+ engagements and 73 unique clients, working with Fitch Learning, LIBF, ADGM Academy, Leoron, Tadawul Academy, EMFT, QFC, and CCL Academy — including direct delivery for QFC.
- Achieved high pass rates in CFA, CISI, and LIBF qualification exams through a practice-focused, participant-centred methodology.
- Designed and delivered an Advanced Financial Crime Compliance programme for Emirates NBD across five specialist divisions and the Second Line of Defence, developed in close collaboration with senior Group Compliance leadership.
- Designed and delivered a bespoke ESG & Sustainable Finance e-learning programme rolled out to 1,200 employees across a major Kuwaiti bank — one of the largest financial learning deployments of its kind in the GCC.
- Created proprietary programmes including the Certificate in Commercial Real Estate Analysis & Investment and Islamic Finance for Everyone (IFfE) — plus own training technology, including a live classroom quiz & analytics web platform built through AI-assisted development.
- Built and delivers AI Fluency for Finance — a seven-course curriculum from 90-minute webinar and executive briefing to a two-day intensive — first commissioned live by Minhaj Advisory and now offered to financial institutions across the GCC.

Head of Islamic Wealth, Holborn Assets, UAE *Sept 2013 – May 2017*

- Negotiated partnerships with Salama senior management, expanding the Islamic product range available to Holborn advisers across the GCC.
- Managed fund screening, risk/return analysis and model portfolio construction.

Principal & IFA, Wealth Focus (FCA Regulated), UK *Feb 2011 – Present*

- Founded and operate an FCA-regulated financial advisory firm in London, specialising in complex pension planning, inheritance tax strategy, and ESG-aligned portfolio management.

IFA, Simply Ethical, UK *May 2011 – Present*

- Advising at the UK's first Islamic independent financial advisory firm, providing Sharia-compliant wealth management including Zakat calculations and interest cleansing; played an active role in its early development, contributing to its initial direction and growth.

Independent Financial Adviser, Positive Solutions, UK *Mar 2005 – May 2011*

Independent Financial Adviser, Inter-Alliance Plc, UK *Mar 2000 – Feb 2005*

PUBLICATIONS

- Which Islamic Finance Qualification — Islamic Finance News (IFN)
- Financial Education in the Classroom based on Islamic and Ethical Values — Education Journal ME
- The Essentials of Financial Planning & Wealth Management — Business Islamica
- Principles of an Islamic Financial System — Business Islamica
- What's Wrong with the Current Financial System — Islamic Finance Review (ISFIRE)

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Chartered Institute for Securities & Investment (CISI)

- Sustainable & Responsible Investment Professional Assessment *Nov 2022*
- Global Financial Compliance *Mar 2021*
- Combating Financial Crime *Feb 2021*
- Kuwait CMA Rules & Regulations *Jan 2021*
- UAE Financial Rules & Regulations *Mar 2019*
- Risk in Financial Services *Jan 2018*
- International Certificate in Wealth & Investment Management *Nov 2017*
- Introduction to Securities & Investment (International) *Jun 2017*
- Fundamentals of Islamic Banking & Finance *Jan 2016*
- Islamic Finance Qualification (IFQ) *Apr 2012*

Chartered Financial Analyst Institute (CFA)

- Certificate in ESG Investing *Feb 2023*
- Investment Foundations Certificate *Oct 2019*

Chartered Insurance Institute (CII)

- Advanced Financial Planning Certificate: G10 Taxation & Trusts, G20 Investment Planning, G60 Pensions, G70 Portfolio Construction *2001–2002*

Academic & Other

- BBS & Japanese (2:1) — University of Limerick *Sept 1995*
- Advanced Diploma, Financial Modelling (Excel & VBA) — Leoron *Aug 2019*